team was particularly pleased to answer his questions about the advanced technology employed in the IGMDP. I stil remember his uncanny curiosity about the indigenous development of carbon-carbon composites. And to let you into a smal secret—Seshan is perhaps the only person in the world who enjoys cal ing me by my ful name which contains 31 letters and five words—Avul Pakir Jainulabdeen Abdul Kalam.

The missile programme had been pursued concurrently and had partners in design, development and production from 12 academic institutions and 30 laboratories from DRDO, the Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR), ISRO and industry. In fact, more than 50 professors and 100 research scholars worked on missile-related problems in the laboratories of their respective institutes. The quality of work achieved through this partnership in that one year had given me tremendous confidence that any development task could be undertaken within the country so long as we have our focussed schedules. Four months before this review, I think it was during April–June 1984, six of us in the missile programme visited academic campuses and enlisted promising young graduates. We